



The Garamut
“The message
sender”

**Ps Barry Reflections from
‘The WORD’!**

**For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL
PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

No.17 For 25th of MAY 2026



OUR THEME: PASTORAL CARE

OUR SCRIPTURE:

Genesis 49: 22 “Joseph is a fruitful bough, a fruitful bough by a spring; his branches RUN OVER the wall. ESV

Genesis 49:22 Joseph is a fruitful vine, a fruitful vine beside a spring; its branches CLIMB OVER the wall. Holman

► **PASTORAL CARE IS LIKE THE BOUGH OF JOSEPH - IT IS ALWAYS REACHING OVER THE WALL.**

JOSEPH’S BRANCHES REACHES OVER THE WALL.

► **TODAY I AM GOING TO LIKEN / RESEMBLE JOSEPH’S BOUGH OR BRANCHES TO PASTORAL CARE OR THE CARE OF A SHEPHERD.**

* *The terms pastor and shepherd are fundamentally the same. The English word "pastor" comes directly from the Latin word pastor, which literally translates to "shepherd".*

► **THE SHEPHERD’S (PASTOR’S) CARE REACHES OVER THE WALL –**

IT IS NOT RESTRICTED TO BY THE MANY DIFFERENT WALLS THAT EXIST IN PEOPLE’S LIVES.

REACHING OVER THE WALL: Represents Joseph’s profound, overwhelming influence and blessing. His life and the prosperity he brought were not meant to be kept contained to his own garden; they spilled over the walls to bless his family, Egypt, and the surrounding nations.

► **WHAT KIND OF PERSON WAS JOSEPH?**

JOSEPH’S

1. **HIS INTEGRITY PURITY- MORAL STRENGTH –** shown when pressured by Potiphar’s wife to be unfaithful, Joseph fled, demonstrating deep self-control and a commitment to moral purity.
2. **HIS HONEST AND PRINCIPLED BELIEFS –** Joseph was a deeply committed man who refused to compromise his values even when it cost him his freedom.
3. **HIS PROFOUND GRACE AND FORGIVENESS – (unmatched) AND OVERCOMING BITTERNESS.** Despite being betrayed, sold and forgotten, Joseph did not continue to hold a grudge. When he was finally reunited with his brothers, **he freely forgave them** and used his power to provide for their families, famously stating; **“you intended to harm me that God intended it for good”** Genesis 50:20.
4. **HIS GOD-CENTERED FAITH IN EVERY SEASON OF HIS LIFE -** whether as a slave, a prisoner, or the second-in-command of Egypt - Joseph credited God for his success and his ability to interpret dreams.

5. **HIS EXCEPTIONAL LEADERSHIP AND WORK ETHIC - STEWARDSHIP:** Whether managing a household, running a prison, or administering an entire nation during a devastating famine, Joseph proved himself to be a highly competent and trustworthy manager.
 6. **JOSEPH'S PATIENCE AND LONG-SUFFERING PERSEVERANCE ARE A LEGEND AND AN EXAMPLE FOR ALL OF GOD'S CHILDREN** -Betrayed by his brothers, sold into slavery, and wrongly imprisoned, he endured over a decade of severe hardship. Despite this, he maintained unwavering faith and actively served others, ultimately becoming a ruler in Egypt.
- ▶ **THE NATURE AND SPIRIT OF JOSEPH PERFECTLY REFLECTS THOSE 'GODLY QUALITIES' EXPRESSED IN AND THROUGH PASTORAL CARE – THE CARE OF A TRUE SHEPHERD.**
- * **PASTORAL CARE SHOULD BE SPONTANEOUS - ARISING OUT OF A HEART OF GENUINE CONCERN AND LOVE FOR PEOPLE.**
 - * **PASTORAL CARE EXPRESSES GOD'S COMPASSIONATE LOVE TOWARDS ALL PEOPLES - AT ALL TIMES REGARDLESS OF ETHNICITY, COLOUR OR RELIGION.**
 - * **PASTORAL CARE SHOWS NO FAVOURITISM OR PARTIALITY** (unfair bias or preference for one person, group, or thing over another.) **PASTORAL CARE DOES NOT DISCRIMINATE.**
 - * **PASTORAL CARE KNOWS NO BOUNDARIES EXCEPT THOSE OF RESPECT, SENSITIVITY AND CONFIDENTIALITY.**
 - * **THERE ARE NO WALLS OR BOUNDARIES THAT PASTORAL CARE CANNOT REACH OVER – but always showing RESPECT, SENSITIVITY and CONFIDENTIALITY** of people's lives.
- ▶ **PASTORAL CARE REACHES OVER THE WALLS OF FEAR, DOUBT.**
- * **IT ALSO REACHES OVER THE WALLS OF REJECTION AND CONDEMNATION. IT REACHES OVER THE WALLS OF PEOPLE'S INSECURITY, POOR SELF-IMAGE AND LOW SELF-ESTEEM** and seeks to help people live confidently as God's children should.
 - * **PASTORAL CARE SEEKS TO REACH OVER THE WALL OF INDIFFERENCE AND THE COULDN'T CARE-LESS ATTITUDE** that often prevails in people's lives.
 - * **PASTORAL CARE DESIRES TO REACH OVER THE WALLS OF ANGER, HATRED, ENVY, PRIDE AND UNFORGIVENESS** PEOPLE STRUGGLE WITH - **showing empathy genuine concern** without condemning or condoning their behaviour but **seeking to help them** start their own journey on the road to love, humility, and forgiveness.
 - * **PASTORAL CARE REACHES OVER THE WALL OF TIMIDITY AND SHYNESS.** It fervently seeks to lift up, encourage and inspire God's children to rise up in confidence and not allow that wall of timidity to continue to enslave and imprison them. *Timidity is the state of lacking self-assurance, courage, or bravery. It is characterized by shyness, a fear of the unfamiliar, and hesitation in making decisions or taking action.*
- * **PASTORAL CARE SEEKS REACHES OVER ANY KIND OF WALL THAT MAN OR THE DEVIL HAS RAISED UP.**

THE APPEAL

CAN WE BE MORE ENGAGED IN SIMPLE PASTORAL CARE –THE EVERYDAY KIND OF CARE THAT WE ARE ALL CAPABLE OF, AND BE LIKE THE BRANCHES OF JOSEPH THAT REACHES OVER THOSE WALLS PEOPLE OR CIRCUMSTANCES HAVE BUILT IN THEIR LIVES, SHOWING THOSE QUALITIES THAT WERE AN INTEGRAL PART OF JOSEPH'S LIFE.

AMEN Ps Barry